

Urban Company

Keeping the InstaHelp Promise

What Urban Company's Play Store complaints say about InstaHelp, and one idea

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59%

of InstaHelp complaints mention a helper not arriving, arriving late or cancelling. For the rest of Urban Company, it's 26%

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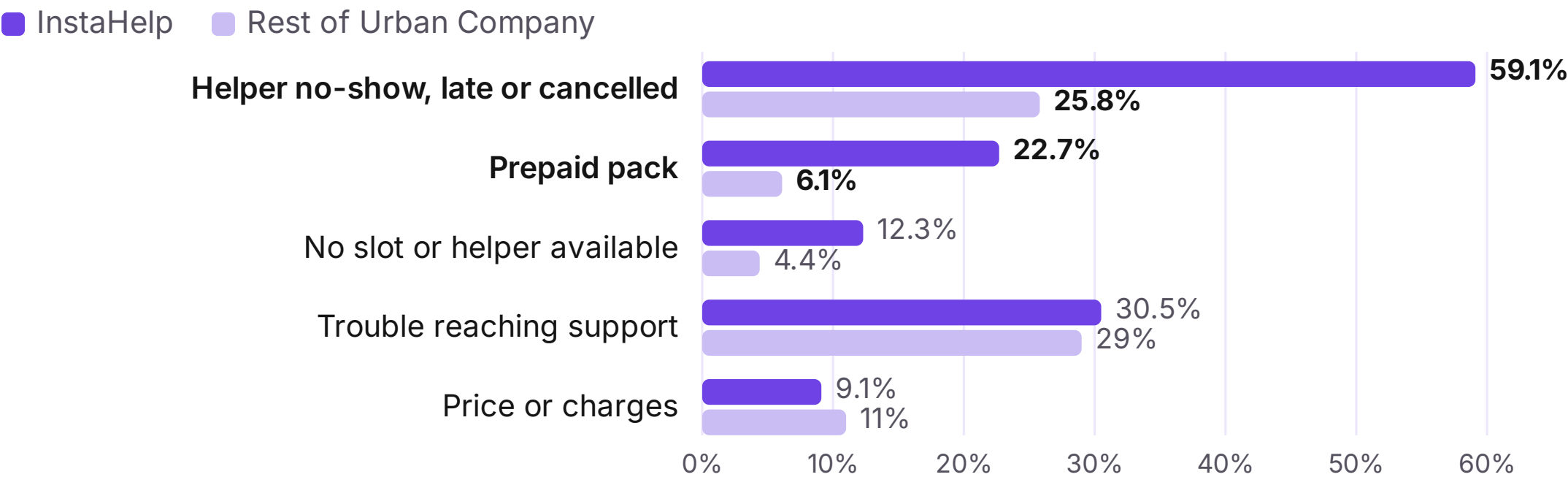
Google Play complaints
17 Aug – 26 Sep 2026

Overview

InstaHelp is Urban Company's fastest-growing service, past a million delivered bookings a month. Since mid-August it appears in **1 in 8 Play Store complaints** about the app, and those complaints look different from the rest: most are about a helper who didn't arrive, arrived late or cancelled.

What complaints are about: InstaHelp vs the rest of Urban Company

Reviews rated 1★–2★, 17 Aug – 26 Sep 2026. 154 mention InstaHelp; 1,050 don't.



154

of 1,204 complaints since 17 Aug mention InstaHelp (13%)

59% vs 26%

mention a no-show, delay or cancellation: InstaHelp vs the rest of UC

23% vs 6%

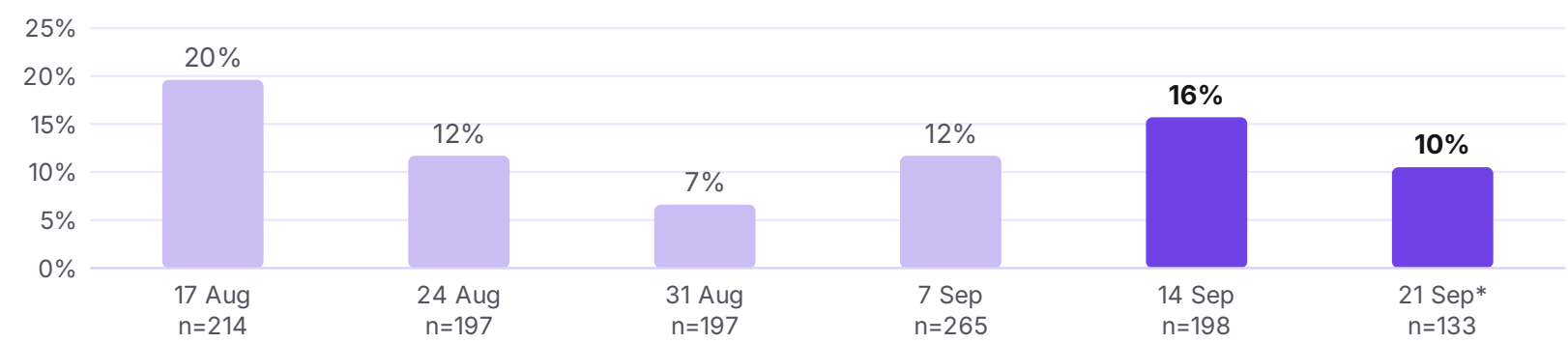
mention a prepaid pack: InstaHelp vs the rest of UC

Source: public Google Play reviews in English, pulled 26–27 Sep 2026. 1★–2★ reviews sorted by keyword rules and spot-checked by hand; about 8 in 10 sorted correctly.

What the reviews show

Complaints mentioning InstaHelp, by week

Share of all Urban Company 1★–2★ reviews. Number of complaints underneath.



*Week to 26 Sep. 52 of the 377 complaints in the last two weeks mention InstaHelp, so this is still current.

“On 21st Aug our booking was confirmed by 10:30 AM for 1:30 PM slot, but no professional arrived, no OTP was taken, no service was provided, yet it was marked “Completed”.”

★☆☆☆☆ Urban Company user · 2026-08-24

“I took a prepaid pack and made a booking for today for insta help they accepted my booking and then cancelled it without providing me with any service saying the maid is not available.”

★☆☆☆☆ Urban Company user · 2026-08-24

“...Everyday they are unavailable whether it's Saturday, Sunday or Monday”

★☆☆☆☆ Urban Company user · 2026-09-20

Why this matters

InstaHelp's promise is a helper in 15 minutes. When a booking is confirmed and nobody comes, the customer has usually planned the day around it, and often paid for a pack. That's why these reviews land so low: since 28 Aug, reviews mentioning InstaHelp average 1.7★, against 3.3★ for the rest.

A booking customers can plan their day around

1 Confirm once a helper accepts

Show "Finding your helper" until someone accepts. If no one does in a few minutes, say so and offer the next slot, before the customer plans around it.

2 Automatic backup helper

If a helper drops out near the slot, the next nearest helper is offered with a new arrival time, instead of a cancellation.

3 Make it right without a chat

When a booking is cancelled from UC's side, a credit or refund lands automatically and the app says so.

4 Protect pack visits

A visit cancelled from UC's side goes back to the pack, and the pack's validity moves by a day.

I couldn't find InstaHelp's pack and cancellation terms publicly, so some of this may already exist. Treat these as starting points.

How I'd know it worked Share of InstaHelp bookings where the helper arrives within 15 minutes of the promised time, by city, every week.
Guardrail: helper idle time doesn't rise from holding backups.